October is

DOWN SYNDROME AWARENESS MONTH

Down Syndrome is the most commonly occurring chromosomal condition in which a person has an extra chromosome. Having an extra chromosome means a child with Down Syndrome may do things differently, but they love to play, learn and be included just like you.

Approximately **1 in 800** babies worldwide is born with Down Syndrome

Common physical traits of Down Syndrome	Common medical concerns associated with Down Syndrome
▪ Low muscle tone ▪ Small stature ▪ An upward slant to the eyes	▪ Congenital heart problems ▪ Respiratory and hearing problems ▪ Eye conditions ▪ Thyroid conditions

IQ is not an accurate measure of ability. Every person with Down Syndrome experiences some cognitive delays but this is not indicative of the many talents and abilities they possess.

Strengths of a person with Down Syndrome include but is not limited to:

- Strong visual learners
- Have the desire and ability to learn from, imitate and take cues from their peers
- Very expressive and have good social skills
- Have empathy and compassion for others
- Are good with technology
- Are good at life skills
- Creative



Children with Down Syndrome do best in inclusive classrooms with appropriate modifications and accommodations.

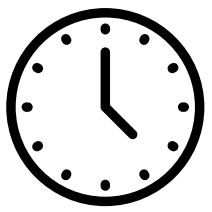
Facts about Down Syndrome



We love to make friends



Speak slowly and clearly. Signs may help us understand.



Speak slowly and clearly. Signs may help us understand.



We enjoy learning through play.



Please use pictures to help us learn.



Be patient with us



Listen carefully to what we say and make sure we can see your face when you speak to us.



We love it when we receive praise - “Well done!” “Great Job!”

The average life expectancy of individuals with Down Syndrome has increased with many living into their **60s and 70s**.

The future is bright!

As a result of improved public attitudes and acceptance, many people with Down Syndrome are active and valued members of the community.



Sania Khimji is an artist, a self-taught dancer and has ventured into professional modelling.



Gopikrishna Varma is an actor who has played the lead role in a commercial film.

DNYANVARDHINI DIVYANG TRAINING COLLEGE

State Commission for Persons with Disabilities GOA

DOWN SYNDROME FEDERATION OF INDIA
40 years of empowering families

SETHU Child Development and Family Guidance